

GOD THE PORTER

Process can be described as a series of actions or steps taken in order to achieve a particular desired end

Sometimes you may use the word 'plan' for a 'process'. A plan could be described as a detailed proposal for doing or achieving something. This something in this description is generally referred to as 'the goal'. A goal is a desired end

The process is therefore a pathway to that desired or predetermined end hence it is made up of time, decisions, actions and inactions, sacrifices, desirables and undesirables.

For anyone to live well with the process then he or she ought to comprehend the desired end. Going through a process for an end that is not known to you can be a total nightmare

Like I have said up there, a process involves lots of favorable and unfavourables, a lot of sacrifices, deliberate decisions, actions and inactions, dos and don'ts dos. Anyone who goes through all these without his knowledge that, it is supposed to be, will do everything possible effort to walk away from this process.

Unfortunately, this is what happens to majority of people. Many people are neither aware of their destiny nor the path to that destiny. Many who happen to get a revelation of what they may be destined for, end up not appreciating the process that ought to birth that destiny

From the Bible, we start with the story of Joseph, the son of Jacob

Genesis 37:3-10

New International Version

³Now Israel loved Joseph more than any of his other sons, because he had been born to him in his old age; and he made an ornate^[a] robe for him. ⁴When his brothers

saw that their father loved him more than any of them, they hated him and could not speak a kind word to him.

⁵Joseph had a dream, and when he told it to his brothers, they hated him all the more. ⁶He said to them, "Listen to this dream I had: ⁷We were binding sheaves of grain out in the field when suddenly my sheaf rose and stood upright, while your sheaves gathered around mine and bowed down to it."

⁸His brothers said to him, "Do you intend to reign over us? Will you actually rule us?" And they hated him all the more because of his dream and what he had said.

⁹Then he had another dream, and he told it to his brothers. "Listen," he said, "I had another dream, and this time the sun and moon and eleven stars were bowing down to me."

¹⁰When he told his father as well as his brothers, his father rebuked him and said, "What is this dream you had? Will your mother and I and your brothers actually come and bow down to the ground before you?"

When the young Joseph had the two dreams, it was clear both to himself, his father and brothers that he was destined for greatness. So, the end was clear but something was not, the path, the process or the plan to that destiny.

God's plan was that Joseph must arrive in Egypt before his family according to God's promise to Abraham recorded in [Genesis 15:13-17](#)

I am thinking of an ambitious young Joseph who now knows for sure that he is destined for greatness. He is excited but alongside this excitement is something ugly that neither Joseph nor his father is familiar with, *jealousy*!

And unknown to Joseph, this hate and jealousy becomes the very *vehicle, path, route, plan and process* to his destiny.

When God's process starts for Joseph, he immediately feels as if the dream is all over certain lost or it is not a reality at all. The events that follow from the day he visits his brothers in the grazing fields and in the subsequent days, weeks, months and years makes it very difficult for him to believe in the reality of the two dreams. Contrary to this feeling, God had since taken over and from that moment on, the dream was more a reality than ever

The dream was exciting. Its meaning was even more exciting but the process is bitter and frustrating. This is how the methods of God look like, contrary to our expectations!

Isaiah 55:8-9

New International Version

⁸"For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways," declares the Lord.

⁹"As the heavens are higher than the earth, so are my ways higher than your ways and my thoughts than your thoughts.

And in [Numbers 23:19](#) God declares that He is neither a man nor a son of man. His ways cannot be the ways of men. His process cannot be the process of men and his plans are not the plans of men.

The processes of God are not only meant for the realization of the end but also to prepare someone for that end. It is meant to teach something necessary for greatness, *humility*.

When Israelites were let go from slavery in Egypt, everyone was excited about the promised land (whose rivers stream with milk and honey [Exodus 3:17](#)). While men were thinking about the end, Canaan, God was concentrating with the way – the process of getting there and it is written that for a good reason God took them through the way of the desert despite there existing a shorter route to Canaan. But God needed time to humble

these people and teach them resilience and obedience because this was fundamental for successful inheritance of the promised land. Canaan had been occupied by tribes who worshiped idols with passion and Israelites needed to be built to resist the temptation of idolatry. See the warnings the Lord gave the people while on the way in

Exodus 13:17-18

New International Version

Crossing the Sea

¹⁷ When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them on the road through the Philistine country, though that was shorter. For God said, "If they face war, they might change their minds and return to Egypt." ¹⁸ So God led the people around by the desert road toward the Red Sea.^[a] The Israelites went out of Egypt ready for battle.

Exodus 20:4, Deuteronomy 5:8-10, Leviticus 26:1 and Exodus 34:12, 15 and 18

The way of God was so frustrating to the Israelites such that they wondered whether Mose's claims to have been sent by God were true or whether God was actually anything good to them. For instance:

Exodus 14:11

New International Version

¹¹ They said to Moses, "Was it because there were no graves in Egypt that you brought us to the desert to die? What have you done to us by bringing us out of Egypt?"

God's process is meant for His glory. He takes glory not by the process but by the end – the results. The process is such a way that it instills humility. Humility is seen in the manner you deal with the greatness – the power - when you finally receive it

Isaiah 64:8-10

New International Version

⁸ Yet you, Lord, are our Father.

We are the clay, you are the potter;
we are all the work of your hand.

See that when God starts to make a greater person from a useless one, then like the clay is squeezed, turned around and burnt, so the Lord does.

Only the potter knows the purpose for which his tool is to serve when it is ready.

For this very reason, the potter will make sure that he takes it through a process that suits the purpose.

Joseph was destined for not only leading a foreign country, but also for having such a big heart to forgive, receive and help his brothers settle in the country where the Lord had purposed long time ago

No matter how challenging the process may be to the one being modelled, God will always get you over it without or with minimal casualties. The challenges you encounter are not by themselves hindrances but rather key memorable stages that are meant to shape your thinking – to know that *it has been God and not your wisdom*. Any scars suffered are meant to be permanent reminders that you were taken through a unique process that modelled you. Remember what Jesus told Thomas

John 20:25-27

New International Version

²⁵ So the other disciples told him, "We have seen the Lord!"

But he said to them, "Unless I see the nail marks in his hands and put my finger where the nails were, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe."

²⁶ A week later his disciples were in the house again, and Thomas was with them. Though the doors were locked, Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with you!" ²⁷ Then he said to Thomas, "Put your finger

here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe."

Anything that tries to interfere with the purpose of God during the special process is calmly or otherwise by the mighty hand of God suppressed. In most cases you do not notice how this happens.

Take key events in the making of Joseph in **Genesis 37. Verse 18 and 19** we see that the initial plan of the Joseph's brothers is to kill him and throw him in a quarry pit. God immediately uses Reuben, one of the brothers to kill that idea. See that their intention is to kill the dream but the dream is the purpose of the entire process, it must come true.

Verses 21-22 we are told that even Reuben in his mercy would stop the purpose of God by rescuing and taking Joseph back to his father. Still God does not allow it. Joseph should not go back. The process of God has begun for him and it must keep forward. Immediately, God brings people who would then pick Joseph with them to Egypt where God wants him to be.

⁵ As they sat down to eat their meal, they looked up and saw a caravan of Ishmaelites coming from Gilead. Their camels were loaded with spices, balm and myrrh, and they were on their way to take them down to Egypt.

²⁶ Judah said to his brothers, "What will we gain if we kill our brother and cover up his blood? ²⁷ Come, let's sell him to the Ishmaelites and not lay our hands on him; after all, he is our brother, our own flesh and blood." His brothers agreed.

²⁸ So when the Midianite merchants came by, his brothers pulled Joseph up out of the cistern and sold him for twenty shekels^[a] of silver to the Ishmaelites, who took him to Egypt.

Now, Joseph is in Egypt and God's plan is that he must stay close to authority for he is destined for authority. God made the trader who purchased him to sell him over at a profit to one of the Pharaoh's officials called Potiphar, a captain of an armed force called The Guard.³⁶ Meanwhile, the Midianites^[b] sold Joseph in Egypt to Potiphar, one of Pharaoh's officials, the captain of the guard.

The Lord gave Joseph favor before his master and was promoted to be personal attendant of the army officer then later he became the custodian of everything that Potiphar owned.

Chapter 39

²The Lord was with Joseph so that he prospered, and he lived in the house of his Egyptian master. ³When his master saw that the Lord was with him and that the Lord gave him success in everything, he did, ⁴Joseph found favor in his eyes and became his attendant. Potiphar put him in charge of his household, and he entrusted to his care everything he owned. ⁵From the time he put him in charge of his household and of all that he owned, the Lord blessed the household of the Egyptian because of Joseph. The blessing of the Lord was on everything Potiphar had, both in the house and in the field. ⁶So Potiphar left everything he had in Joseph's care; with Joseph in charge, he did not concern himself with anything except the food he ate.

See that this is a progressive process that suffers no unwanted stagnation. For good or for worse, Joseph should not delay in one stage for too much longer. Joseph may feel that being an attendant to Potiphar and having been put in charge of all that his master owned is enough but God's process is not yet over. Joseph must be moved again and again until he is a final product of God. Before he starts to enjoy the comfort of the house of his master, and a good salary, he finds himself in prison!

Chapter 39

¹³When she saw that he had left his cloak in her hand and had run out of the house, ¹⁴she called her household servants. "Look," she said to them, "this Hebrew has been brought to us to make sport of us! He came in here to sleep with me, but I screamed. ¹⁵When he heard me scream for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house."

¹⁶She kept his cloak beside her until his master came home. ¹⁷Then she told him this story: "That Hebrew slave you brought us came to me to make sport of me. ¹⁸But as soon as I screamed for help, he left his cloak beside me and ran out of the house."

¹⁹When his master heard the story his wife told him, saying, "This is how your slave treated me," he burned with anger. ²⁰Joseph's master took him and put him in prison, the place where the king's prisoners were confined.

The Lord gave Joseph favor with the prison Warden and Joseph was promoted to be in charge of the prisoners.

He is not an ordinary prisoner, but a prisoner of the Lord. A prisoner on God's mission. Yet again Joseph will not stay in prison for long and God has a plan ready to get him out and land him to the highest office in the land.

Genesis 41

English Standard Version

Joseph Interprets Pharaoh's Dreams

⁴¹After two whole years, Pharaoh dreamed that he was standing by the Nile, ²and behold, there came up out of the Nile seven cows, attractive and plump, and they fed in the reed grass. ³And behold, seven other cows, ugly and thin, came up out of the Nile after them, and stood by the other cows on the bank of the Nile. ⁴And the ugly, thin cows ate up the seven attractive, plump cows. And Pharaoh awoke. ⁵And he fell asleep and dreamed a second time. And behold, seven ears of grain, plump and good, were growing on one stalk. ⁶And behold, after them

sprouted seven ears, thin and blighted by the east wind. ⁷And the thin ears swallowed up the seven plump, full ears. And Pharaoh awoke, and behold, it was a dream. ⁸So in the morning his spirit was troubled, and he sent and called for all the magicians of Egypt and all its wise men. Pharaoh told them his dreams, but there was none who could interpret them to Pharaoh.

¹⁴Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they quickly brought him out of the pit. And when he had shaved himself and changed his clothes, he came in before Pharaoh.

Verses 25-36 Joseph interprets Pharaoh's dream and in verse 37 down he is promoted to the second in command, in the land not his own. Now, Joseph, finally at the age of 30 he has become the product God has been making. He has built a character and reputation that God wanted him to have.

More importantly, Joseph through out this journey has come to realize that, God was with him and that every single event had been orchestrated by God for the purpose only God knew.

He remembers the conversation of his brothers at the grazing field and that they even suggested to kill him. His escape of death was procured by God.

In the house of Potiphar, just when he thought all trouble had ended, he is accused of attempted rape by his master's wife. He may well have been shot dead or killed in any other way but ends up in a prison. He finds favor with the prison warden. Eventually he can interpret dreams inside the prison something that two years later land him in the palace and now he is formally appointed second in command. Oh! Joseph knows very well this must have been God.

In the process, Joseph has acquired a big heart to forgive and hold nothing against his foes. He has acquired the art of leadership, responsibility and accountability. He has

learned values of honesty, truthful and hate for sin (which reciprocate the fear of the Lord)

Soon after Joseph receiving his entire father's family to Egypt, God withdraws his grace from him. The Bible says that the Pharaoh who knew and loved Joseph died and another one arose to power. The new ruler knew nothing about Joseph and did not show his people mercy. Slavery began according to the plan of God

Josephs now knows what the plan of God about him was and by the time he died at the age of 110 years, he is aware that he has served the purpose of God for him. In **Genesis 50:24-26** he tells his brothers that God was going to come for their deliverance from Egypt back to the land of promise.

Exodus 1:

⁶ Now Joseph and all his brothers and all that generation died, ⁷ but the Israelites were exceedingly fruitful; they multiplied greatly, increased in numbers and became so numerous that the land was filled with them.

⁸ Then a new king, to whom Joseph meant nothing, came to power in Egypt. ⁹ "Look," he said to his people, "the Israelites have become far too numerous for us. ¹⁰ Come, we must deal shrewdly with them or they will become even more numerous and, if war breaks out, will join our enemies, fight against us and leave the country."

If you think or know you are in a making process of God I would like to tell you that nothing can stop that will of God for you except your unwillingness. There shall be no danger to threat the purpose of God and if you allow the will of God to make you, soon you will become that final product of the Lord. David said out of experience especially during the years Saul hunted to kill him that he had learned that even death or darkness would never overcome him for the Lord was with him!

Psalm 23:4

New International Version

**⁴ Even though I walk
through the darkest valley,
I will fear no evil,
for you are with me;
your rod and your staff,
they comfort me.**

Once you have discovered you are in a process of God's making, take off fear, be of good courage and allow God to take care of everything. There shall be nothing to overcome you.

God told all the men he chose to be of good courage, not to be afraid and not to despair for He was with them all the time and everywhere. **Joshua 1:9, Exodus 3:12, Exodus 33:14**

Step forward if you want the prayer of courage, perseverance and determination to see through a process of God's making.

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